CELPIP EXPRESS

Reading Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 17

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Read the following message.

Dear Ara,

Thank you for submitting your insurance claim to our office. I have finished reviewing it, including your photos of the water-damaged items and the original purchase receipts for them. I appreciated the itemized spreadsheet you included.

You have claimed the cost of replacing your desktop computer, which was for personal use only and damaged in the flood. The computer cannot be repaired, so the cost of replacing it is approved. However, your spreadsheet also itemizes the cost of a 3-year extended warranty, purchased along with the computer. Since the computer is 7 years old, the warranty coverage has expired. We cannot pay for the expired warranty portion of your computer costs.

You have also claimed the cost of the goods and services tax (GST) on the original purchase price of items that were damaged. Unfortunately, we pay this cost only on items that have been purchased as replacements. Therefore, for any replacement item you purchase, please submit the receipt to us. Note that interest on credit card purchases is not covered.

Regarding the wool carpet samples, you indicated that these are the property of the flooring company you work for. Our policy covers only property owned and used by you personally, so, I'm sorry, but we cannot cover the cost of the damaged carpet samples.

When it's time for you to renew your policy with us next spring, we recommend that you purchase additional insurance for items stored in your home but owned by or used in your business. This would protect you not only against the type of loss you recently experienced, but also against other risks such as fire.

Your adjusted total is $16,400. Our accounting department will issue you a cheque on the 15th of this month. If you would prefer to pick it up rather than receive it by mail, please let me know by this Wednesday at the latest.

As a valued long-time client, please accept warmest wishes from our family of companies. We wish you every success in recovering from your losses this past August, and we are pleased to have been able to assist you.

Regards,

Nelson Lowe

Choose the **best** option according to the information given in the message.

1. What caused Ara's situation? _____
- ◯ an accident at home
- ◯ an error on a tax form
- ◯ an expired insurance policy
- ◯ an incorrect charge at a store

2. Nelson approved _____
- ◯ interest fees on credit card purchases.
- ◯ the remaining warranty on the computer.
- ◯ replacement costs for the carpet samples.
- ◯ the cost of a new desktop computer.

3. What is Ara most likely to do next?
- ◯ have her damaged personal computer repaired
- ◯ decide whether to call Nelson about the cheque
- ◯ use the gift card that Nelson enclosed
- ◯ send Nelson the full amount owing on the bill

4. Nelson wants Ara to _____
- ◯ insure business items separately.
- ◯ purchase a longer computer warranty.
- ◯ eliminate household fire hazards.
- ◯ remove her water-damaged carpeting.

5. Nelson probably works _____
- ◯ for a furniture repair shop.
- ◯ for a large corporation.
- ◯ as a small business owner.
- ◯ as Ara's business partner.

6. Nelson wrote this message mainly to _____
- ◯ apologize to Ara.
- ◯ collect money from Ara.
- ◯ explain changes to Ara.
- ◯ send good wishes to Ara.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Here is a response to the message. Complete the response by filling in the blanks.

Dear Nelson,

Thank you for your message.

I'm glad to hear that you 7._____ . I didn't realize that the warranty on my computer had expired; 8._____ that in my claim.

I have two questions. First, before the flood happened, I brought the carpet samples home 9._____ because we're redecorating our living room and wanted to choose new carpeting. I'm not actually using the house for business purposes or to store business supplies. Regarding the samples, does this new information affect 10._____ ?

Second, would I get a discount on car insurance if I switched from my current company to you, since I already have house insurance with you? I realize this question is 11._____ the claim at hand, but I would appreciate your response when convenient.

Sincerely,

Ara

7. ◯ aim to improve client service
   ◯ can make sense of what I owe
   ◯ found my spreadsheet helpful
   ◯ have put the cheque in the mail

8. ◯ my apologies for including
   ◯ thank you for including
   ◯ I was correct to include
   ◯ it was too late to include

9. ◯ secretly
   ◯ temporarily
   ◯ reluctantly
   ◯ accidentally

10. ◯ their goods and services tax rate for the year
    ◯ my household possessions insurance expiry date
    ◯ our costs for having them installed in our house
    ◯ your decision to classify them as business items

11. ◯ critical to
    ◯ unrelated to
    ◯ part of
    ◯ complicating

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 2

Custom Chocolates Menu

All confections except truffles and fudge come in nine different shapes: cube, cone, triangle, rose, leaf, daisy, star, crescent, and swirling spiral.

	PRALINE PERFECTION **Go nuts over praline!** Price Range: $$$ (high) A blend of finely chopped hazelnuts, almonds, and pecans smothered in dark or light milk chocolate
	MARZIPAN MARVELS **An almond-lover's delight!** Price Range: $ (low) A delightfully smooth paste of finely ground almonds and confectioners' sugar, enrobed in light milk chocolate
	GANACHE GOODIES **Ganache any way you like it!** Price Range: $$$ (high) A creamy blend of 85% chocolate mixed with rich cream that comes in plain, raspberry, coconut, mint, and coffee flavours Option of light or dark chocolate
	FUDGE FANTASIES **A traditional favourite!** Price Range: $$ (moderate) A cube or slice of melt-in-your-mouth sugar candy that comes in maple, butter pecan, walnut, pistachio, and nut-free vanilla options—ask about our sugar-free option Available in cube shape only
	TRUFFLE TREASURES **A treat that's also a treasure!** Price Range: $$$$ (very high) A sphere of light or dark chocolate, filled with ganache or liquor and lightly dusted with chocolate cocoa powder Centre options are coffee-flavoured liqueur, orange-flavoured liqueur, or fruit-flavoured brandy Available in sphere shape only

Read the following email message about the diagram on the left. Complete the email by filling in the blanks

Subject: Chocolates
To: Roger Neufeld <rogerneufeld@burdys.com>
From: Vincent Mathijs <vmathijs@burdys.com>

Good morning Roger,

Hope you had a great weekend. As promised, here's my draft of the concept for our next product line. The concept is to simplify and logically group our range of chocolate confections.

Customers still have plenty of options—but there won't be any 1._____ . Informal market research showed that the most popular item among the available options was the marzipan in the 2._____ shape.

One strategy behind the product range is to stand out from our competitors by 3._____ . Another strategy was to follow the consumer trend toward healthier options that limit the intake of particular ingredients. The 4._____ products are specifically designed to fill this need.

Well, those are my ponderings on this concept. What are yours? If I could have your feedback before next Friday, I'd really appreciate it.

Thanks in advance for your input.

Vincent Mathijs, 5._____

1. ◯ leaf-shaped marzipan
   ◯ praline rose blossoms
   ◯ globe-shaped truffles
   ◯ star-shaped fudge

2. ◯ long rectangle
   ◯ swirling spiral
   ◯ ringed planet
   ◯ tulip blossom

3. ◯ focusing just on rich dark chocolate
   ◯ having a clearly organized collection
   ◯ lightly dusting all the treats with sugar
   ◯ offering twenty different kinds of nuts

4. ◯ fudge
   ◯ ganache
   ◯ praline
   ◯ truffle

5. ◯ Accounts Receivable Officer
   ◯ Founder and International CEO
   ◯ Product Development Specialist
   ◯ Shipping and Receiving Manager

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 2

Choose the best option.

6. If you want to avoid almonds, what are your only options?

- ◯ chocolates in geometric shapes
- ◯ dark milk chocolate products
- ◯ just the costliest products
- ◯ truffles, ganache, and fudge

7. What do we know for sure about Vincent and Roger?

- ◯ Vincent and Roger work in the same department.
- ◯ Roger must receive the chocolates before Friday.
- ◯ Vincent is Roger's supervisor at a chocolate factory.
- ◯ Roger had been expecting Vincent's message.

8. What should Roger do after he reads the message?

- ◯ acknowledge the merits and suggest improvements
- ◯ draft a proposal for a different chocolate collection
- ◯ send the requested market research results data
- ◯ taste and critique the various sample chocolates

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 3

Read the following passage.

A. Photographs of spectacular rainbows are a dime a dozen, but a similar event seldom witnessed is the occurrence of moonbows. While rainbows are caused by beams of sunlight refracting through water droplets in the atmosphere, moonbows, as their name suggests, are created by beams of moonlight refracting through moisture in the air. However, this is where the similarity to rainbows ends. These nighttime bows, also referred to as lunar rainbows, are a much rarer phenomenon, occurring only at particular times of the year and limited by geographic requirements.

B. A distinct combination of astronomical and meteorological conditions is required in order for a moonbow to occur. For one, the moon must be bright, such as during a full or nearly full moon. Moreover, the moon must be low in the sky, no more than 42 degrees above the horizon. The lower the elevation of the moon, the fuller the lunar rainbow. Finally, there must be water droplets present in the atmosphere. The optimal conditions occur on nights during which there are rain showers falling opposite the moon and the sky is clear. Mist from waterfalls can also create the appropriate amount of moisture in the atmosphere. Under these precise conditions, a viewer standing with his or her back to the moon could potentially observe a moonbow.

C. Although multicoloured, the bands of the arc of a moonbow appear as various shades of grey to the naked eye. This can be attributed to physiological factors. Because it is difficult for the human eye to discern colours at low levels of illumination, such as in the darkness of night, the multihued bow appears white or grey. Nonetheless, the magnificent colours of lunar bows can be picked up in long-exposure photographs, even though the arc appears monochrome to the photographer.

D. Because of the specific combination of conditions required, moonbows are more prevalent in certain locations around the world, particularly those that have waterfalls. Such moonbows form fairly regularly at Yosemite Falls in California, Cumberland Falls in Kentucky, and Victoria Falls on the border of Zambia and Zimbabwe in Africa. In fact, moonbow predictions at some of these locations can be found on various websites. The appearance of lunar rainbows is also common in the cloud forests of Costa Rica and in certain areas of Hawaii. If you are fortunate enough to be at the right place at the right time, you may be able to catch a glimpse of this magnificent phenomenon.

E. Not given in any of the above paragraphs.

Decide which paragraph, A to D, has the information given in each statement below.

Select E if the information is not given in any of the paragraphs.

1. The orientation of the moon in relation to the earth impacts the intensity of the bow.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

2. Moonbows occur less frequently than their daytime counterparts.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

3. Specific circumstances must occur simultaneously in order to create a moonbow.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

4. Images of rainbows are much more common than images of moonbows.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

5. Moonbows are often seen on nights when the moon is high in the sky.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

6. Specific geographical sites are more suitable for lunar rainbows.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

7. It is possible to obtain forecasts for some moonbow occurrences.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

8. Perception of moonbow colours is hindered by lack of light.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

9. Observers have claimed to see moonbows during crescent moon phases.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 4

Read the following article from a website.

Smartphones and other technological paraphernalia have invaded our lives. We are now surrounded by people eschewing social etiquette by compulsively checking their phones, drawn automatically to the incessant "ding" of their notifications. The ubiquity and nature of this modern technology have made concentrating on anything for more than a moment feel like a Herculean task. Young children are particularly at risk, since their neurological development is not yet complete.

The impression that children are negatively affected by personal computing devices is reflected in anecdotal evidence from classrooms, where teachers increasingly report shortened attention spans in pupils. Lisa Cranberg, a veteran elementary school teacher, believes that "exposure to technology is rewiring our kids' brains." For her, "children spending extended periods of time interacting solely with their smartphones is showing diminished self-awareness, emotional intelligence, and focus." In essence, she believes that overstimulation is making it difficult for students to concentrate in a traditional lecture-centric classroom.

Not everyone is as anxious, however, about technological advances. Dr. Clara Hughes of the University of Waterloo agrees that shifts in stimuli are resulting in cerebral rewiring, with ramifications that might include shorter attention spans. However, she claims that developing these mechanisms that allow us to partake in rapid-fire attention shifting is actually "beneficial to creative types whose job is to amalgamate disparate ideas." She surmises that our brains are simply adapting to the level of stimulation inherent to our environment.

In fact, while technology can be harmful to concentration, a new wave of research is unearthing a whole slew of unforeseen beneficial effects. "Modern technology is bettering our ability to multitask and concentrate in short bursts," according to neuropsychologist Dr. Mark Levinson. This means that "we get a better sense of what deserves our attention, and there is an improved selection of the information we commit to memory."

Dr. Hughes is more moderate in her analysis, saying that "overexposure and gadget addiction do have a demonstrably negative effect on many cognitive behaviours." Nevertheless, she concurs with Dr. Levinson's overall beneficial assessment of the neurological side-effects of our interactions with digital technologies.

Choose the **best** option according to the information given on the website.

1. The intent of the first paragraph is to _____

- ◯ complain about a technology-linked decline in social skills.
- ◯ describe recent advances in digital communication technology.
- ◯ criticize the detrimental overuse of communication devices.
- ◯ warn about how smartphones may impact children's brains.

2. Ms. Cranberg's opinion stems from her _____

- ◯ experiences with her own children.
- ◯ observations over the years.
- ◯ research on emotional intelligence.
- ◯ use of traditional lectures.

3. Dr. Hughes' main point is that our _____

- ◯ behaviour indicates shortened attention spans.
- ◯ brains are benefiting by becoming more creative.
- ◯ behaviours are being negatively affected.
- ◯ brains are adapting to new technologies.

4. Dr. Hughes and Ms. Cranberg would agree that _____

- ◯ communication technology overuse may lower emotional intelligence.
- ◯ smartphones may contribute to higher academic achievement.
- ◯ electronic devices can foster creativity in young people.
- ◯ children can better multi-task thanks to electronic devices.

5. Dr. Levinson would likely agree that _____

- ◯ children can benefit from using technological devices.
- ◯ the impacts of digital devices deserve more attention.
- ◯ our brains need stimulation from digital devices.
- ◯ technological devices can harm our memory processes.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 4

The following is a comment by a visitor to the website page. Complete the comment by choosing the best option to fill in each blank.

I've never really thought about the effect of emerging technologies on neurological development, but as a parent of four youngsters, this piece certainly piqued my interest! After reading the various viewpoints, I felt that 6. _____ neglected to mention the potentially negative consequences of diminishing attention spans. 7. _____ numerous valuable effects of human-computer interactions, such as improvements in the ability to simultaneously execute multiple activities, assemble contrasting information, and sort out facts. Meanwhile, I was disappointed by the alarmist views on 8. _____ expressed by Ms. Cranberg. 9. _____ should be a blessing for teachers and classrooms. 10. _____ traditional educational methods, as Ms. Cranberg insinuates, then these methods need to be adapted to the way children consume information in their daily lives.

6. ◯ the author
   ◯ Dr. Hughes
   ◯ Ms. Cranberg
   ◯ Dr. Levinson

7. ◯ This article also disparages the
   ◯ Additionally, the stakeholders ignore
   ◯ But I agree that there are
   ◯ Only the teacher appreciates the

8. ◯ the declining quality of homework
   ◯ disorderly student behaviours
   ◯ teachers' reporting practices
   ◯ students and electronic devices

9. ◯ New informational inputs
   ◯ Modified cognitive behaviours
   ◯ Children's improved curiosity
   ◯ Tried-and-true teaching methods

10. ◯ When teachers are tired of
    ◯ If children are not engaged by
    ◯ Since technology has improved
    ◯ Unless students prefer

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	an accident at home
Question 2	the cost of a new desktop computer.
Question 3	decide whether to call Nelson about the cheque
Question 4	insure business items separately.
Question 5	for a large corporation.
Question 6	explain changes to Ara.
Question 7	found my spreadsheet helpful
Question 8	my apologies for including
Question 9	temporarily
Question 10	your decision to classify them as business items
Question 11	unrelated to

PART 2	
Question 1	star-shaped fudge
Question 2	swirling spiral
Question 3	having a clearly organized collection
Question 4	fudge
Question 5	Product Development Specialist
Question 6	truffles, ganache, and fudge
Question 7	Roger had been expecting Vincent's message.
Question 8	acknowledge the merits and suggest improvements

PART 3	
Question 1	B
Question 2	A
Question 3	B
Question 4	A
Question 5	E
Question 6	D
Question 7	D
Question 8	C
Question 9	E

PART 4	
Question 1	criticize the detrimental overuse of communication devices.
Question 2	observations over the years.
Question 3	brains are adapting to new technologies.
Question 4	communication technology overuse may lower emotional intelligence.
Question 5	children can benefit from using technological devices.
Question 6	Dr. Levinson
Question 7	But I agree that there are
Question 8	students and electronic devices
Question 9	New informational inputs
Question 10	If children are not engaged by

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